

Sarah Sherman

Washington, DC | shermansarah@pm.me | [linkedin.com/in/sarahrsherman](https://www.linkedin.com/in/sarahrsherman)

SUMMARY

UX researcher and strategist with deep experience turning ambiguous product questions into practical research plans for complex, sensitive, multi-step digital experiences. Trusted partner to product, design, engineering, legal/compliance, analytics, and operations teams, with a track record of translating research into clear decisions, prioritized recommendations, and measurable product outcomes.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Manager, Loan Origination and Customer Acquisition Caribou Financial

Aug. 2023-July 2026

- Led pre- and post-launch research strategy for a new agent-facing loan-origination system. Pre- and post-launch research led to direct iterations and system improvements, and ultimately a 13.2% lower document delay rate, 8.4% lower average talk time, and 10.7% decrease in talk minutes per approval versus the standard workflow, over the course of a 5-month rollout.
- Led user research for the redesign of the prequalified offers page in Caribou's customer-facing application. Transformed the page from desktop-first to mobile-first and highlighted best offers, improving page throughput by 6%
- Launched new integrated experience with lead-generating partner Credit Karma after evaluating and improving UX to align with customer, business, and partner needs; this new experience led directly to an additional 213 funded loans in its rollout period.

Lead Design Strategist Oportun

Sept. 2019 - Aug. 2023

- Delivered 40+ user research projects across personal loans, secured personal loans, credit card, collections, marketing, and mobile experiences; within these projects, completed a total of 266 moderated and unmoderated customer interviews across marketing, mobile app, website, banking, savings, and loan-servicing initiatives.
- Led all user research for the beta launch of the Oportun native mobile app, including customer interviews, unmoderated testing, and competitor analysis. After 14 months in production, the app processed more than 26k payment transactions; ~65% of all users made multiple in-app payments.
- Delivered Oportun's first Collections-focused service blueprint and actionable recommendations to reduce agent error and exposure to regulatory fines by up to 30%. Research included: system testing, 15 agent interviews, 30+ call and screen-recordings, 2500 internal agent scorecards, 41 agent survey responses (Spanish and English), and new agent training materials.
- Owned UserTesting onboarding, system training, recurring vendor management, and testing practices for the Design Strategy team.

Senior Digital Designer II GEICO

June 2015 - Aug. 2019

- Developed conversational UX strategy across chatbot, IVR, and customer-facing application experiences to implement GEICO's first experiments with AI tooling.
- Developed more than 1,000 conversational AI content items and coordinated enterprise review for accuracy, policy fit, and state regulatory requirements.

EDUCATION

Master of Science, Information | University of Michigan Ann Arbor

Bachelor of Arts, English Language and Literature | University of Maryland College Park